



Cellphone Battle Royale

*Visbal Matbur
Siddharth Chaudhan
teamdigit@thinkdigit.com*

The growth in the smartphone market isn't showing any signs of abating. A Frost & Sullivan report predicts that by the year 2015, about 477 million smartphones would have been sold in Asia. That gives it a total share of 54 per cent in the overall mobile phone market, up from just 9 percent in 2009.

The major reason is that the entry price point for smartphones is lower than ever before and you now also get more bang for your buck, despite these low prices. That's not all though, with a variety of platforms to choose from – Android, Symbian, Blackberry and Apple's iOS – there was never a better time to be a smartphone consumer. Sky's the limit.

Loser gets hung, drawn and quartered

The ₹10,000 - ₹20,000 price bracket for smartphones sees possibly the most cut-throat competition.
Which phone should you buy?

Our 2011 cellphone shoot-out edition takes a look at the smartphones in the price band between ₹10,000 and ₹20,000. It's only fitting that we do this just in time for the Diwali shopping frenzy. The winners will deserve the moolah you may spend to buy one of them, while

the losers can keep working towards cracking the code and making huge inroads into the Indian market.

₹10K - ₹13K

If you have a budget that falls between ₹10,000 and ₹12,999, then the choice is pretty wide,

as far as Android smartphones are concerned. We've got ten of those in this test, and four of them are the touchscreen + physical QWERTY keypad combo ones. However, beware that buying a budget touchscreen phone does have its own little shortcomings. First off, the hardware won't be as good as a high-end smartphone. Everything - including the processor, RAM, display quality and the touchscreen responsiveness - will have slight unpolished edges. While this disclaimer doesn't aim to change your mind against buying a phone in this range, it will help you guard against any expectations that these phones will be like the premium phones.

Features, build and usability: Since we have phones of two different form factors, we'll take a look at each of them separately. First, let's deal with the